Climate Adaptation 2026

Resilience Investment Case Explorer (RICE):

A Scalable Digital Decision Tool for Climate Resilience Investment Decisions

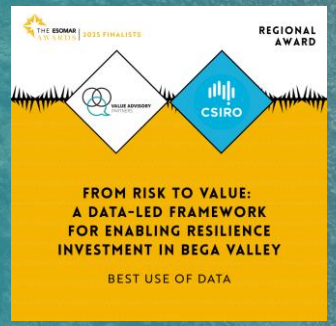
From fragmented studies to a shared decision environment for investment

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THE CONTEXT



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Source: John Cutler

THE PROBLEM

Adaptation decisions break down at the hand-off

01
Hazard and risk

Evidence about exposure, vulnerability, and consequence

02
Adaptation pathways

Resilience-building options, timing, and sequencing under uncertainty

03
Economic case

Costs, benefits, and distributional effects of the investment

04
Funding and delivery

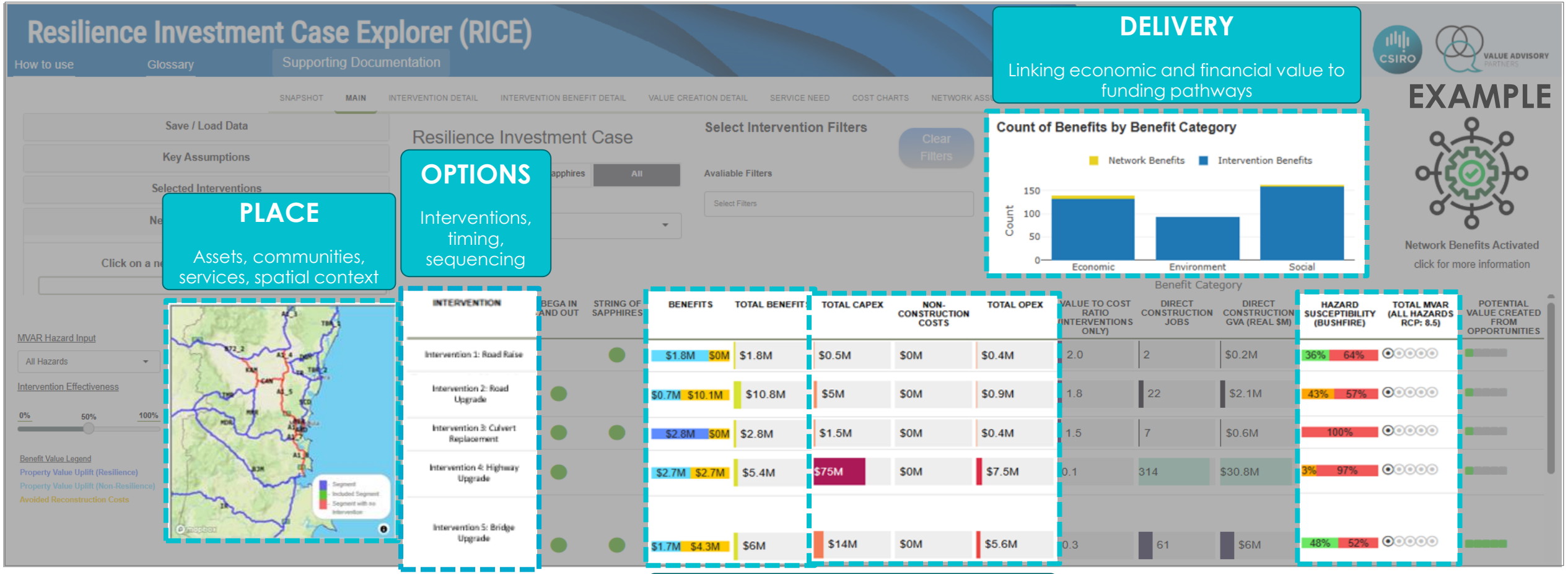
Business cases, grants, budget expenditure, and implementation options

Different owners, tools, and timeframes create information loss, siloed responsibilities, and out-of-sequence decisions

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THE DIGITAL RESPONSE

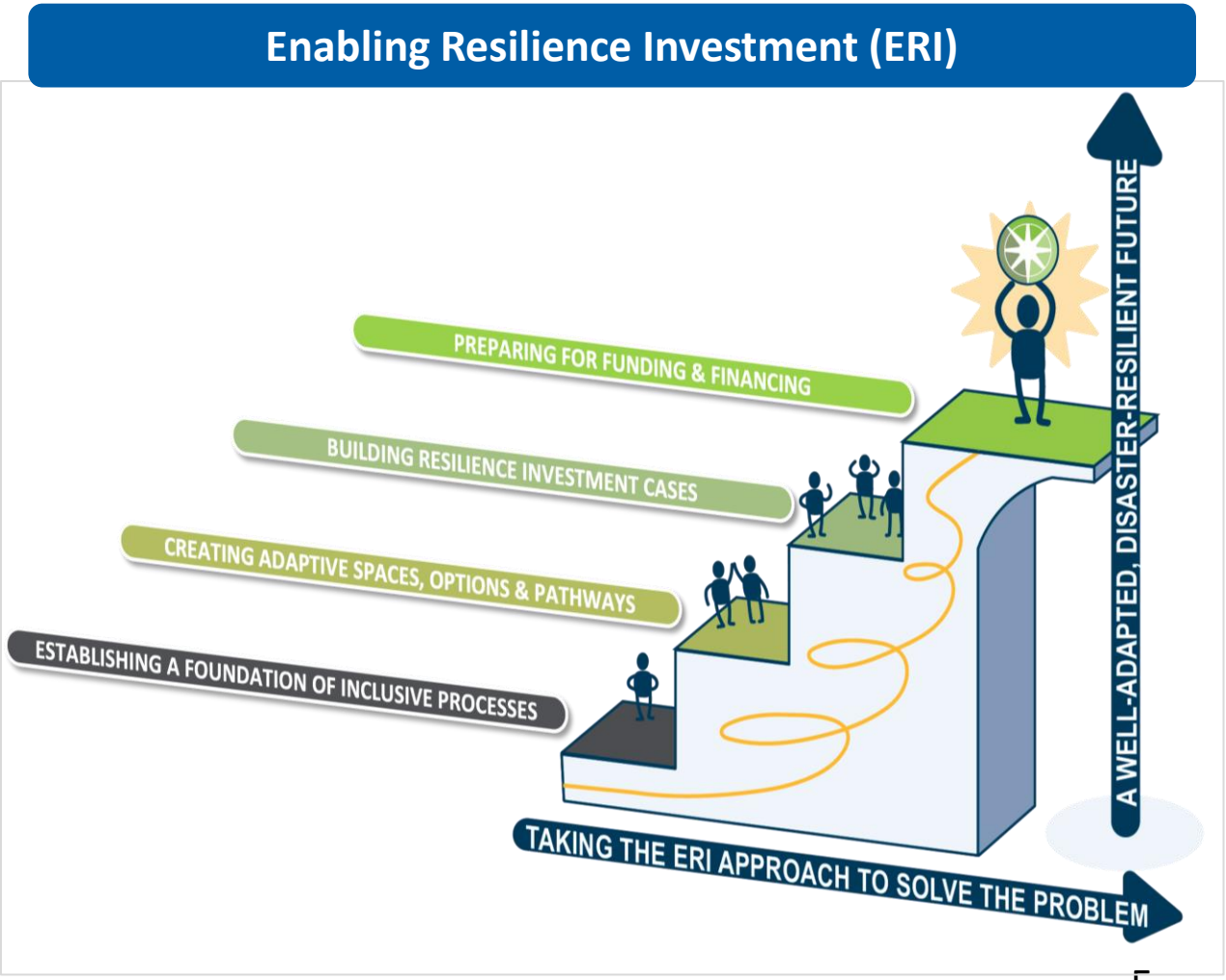
The Resilience Investment Case Explorer (RICE) creates one shared environment



Source: Value Advisory Partners, 2024

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The platform sits inside a broader co-design process



Source: Wise et. Al (2022). Enabling Resilience Investment Guidance version 1. CSIRO and Value Advisory Partners

ERI CO-DESIGN

Builds a shared view of the system, key climate hazards and risks, and prioritises which assets and services will be explored for resilience-building

RESILIENCE INVESTMENT CASES

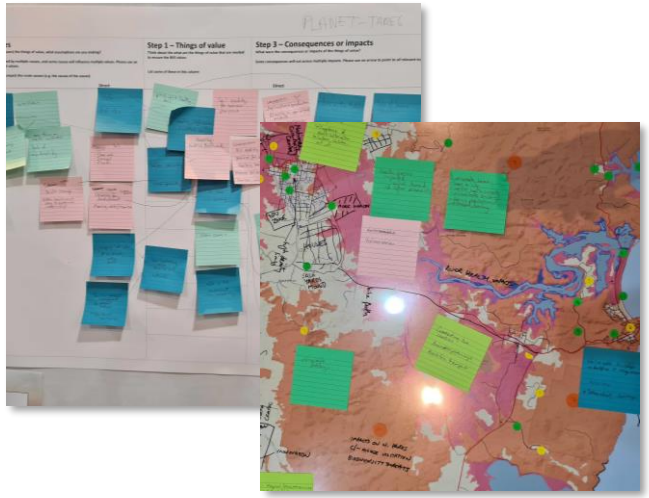
Develops the investment logic, supporting evidence, and value proposition for resilience interventions to address the hazard risk

THE TOOL: RICE

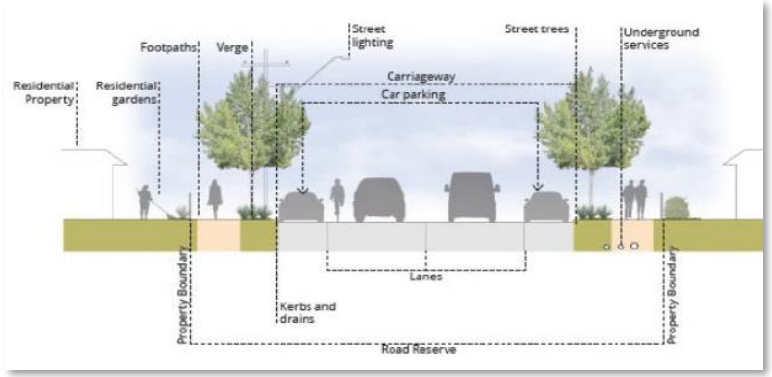
Retains and connects the evidence so users can test assumptions, explore scenarios, prioritise and bundle interventions, and understand implications for funding and delivery

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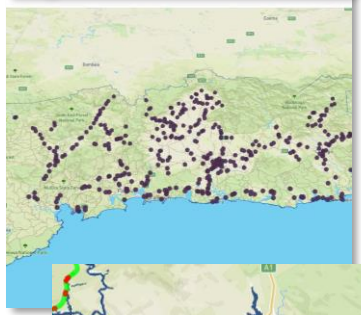
ERI takes a participatory approach to create structured, traceable, place-based evidence



Example: Agreement on focal assets, services, and users impacted by climate hazard



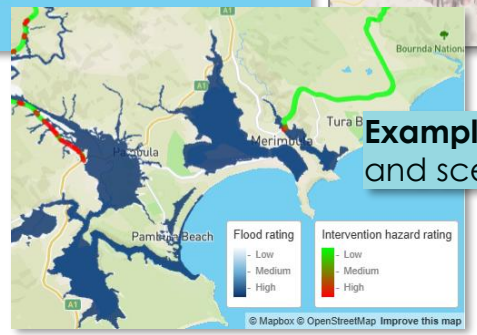
Example: Asset register



Example: Dwelling/population growth



Example: Climate hazards and scenarios



LOCAL KNOWLEDGE

The process take a place-based view of resilience, relying on local knowledge and data to provide the contextual and technical details necessary to carry out the analyses

SHARED INTERPRETATION

A diverse group of stakeholders define the problem, scope, and options together, creating a shared view of risk and resilience

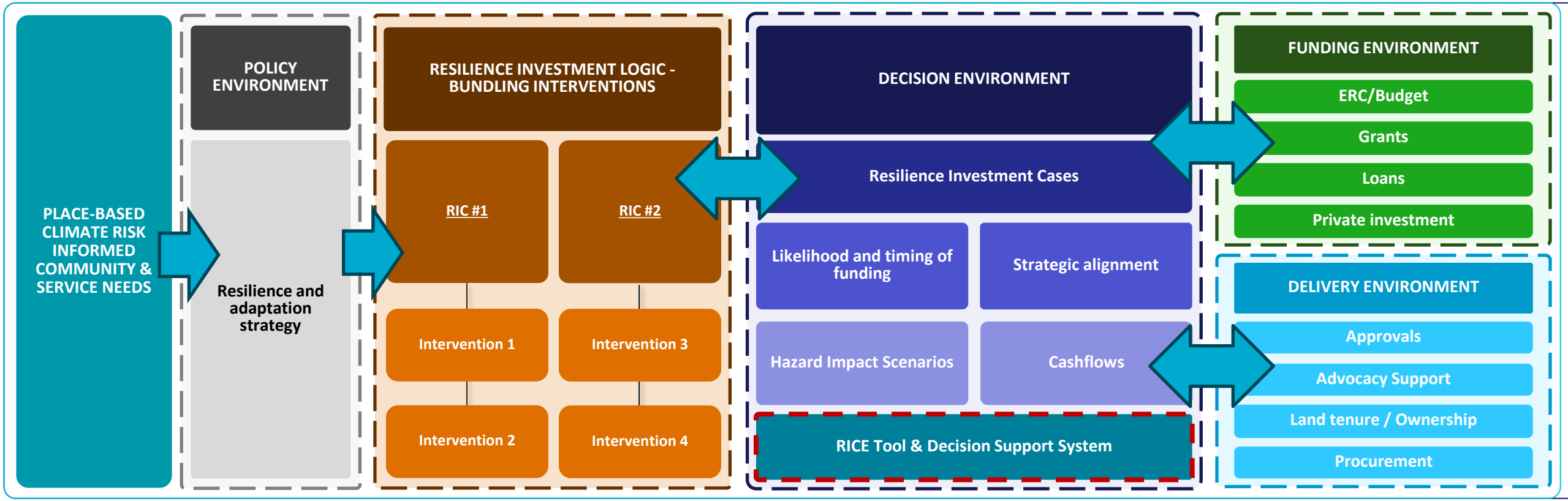
DECISION-READY EVIDENCE

Data and evidence from multiple sources covering climate, hazard risk, socio-demographics, assets and infrastructure, key services, and costs are analysed, integrated, and connected to provide a comprehensive and consistent evidence-base

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THE DECISION-MAKING CONTEXT

The RICE tool is a decision-support system within a broader strategic and operational decision-making environment

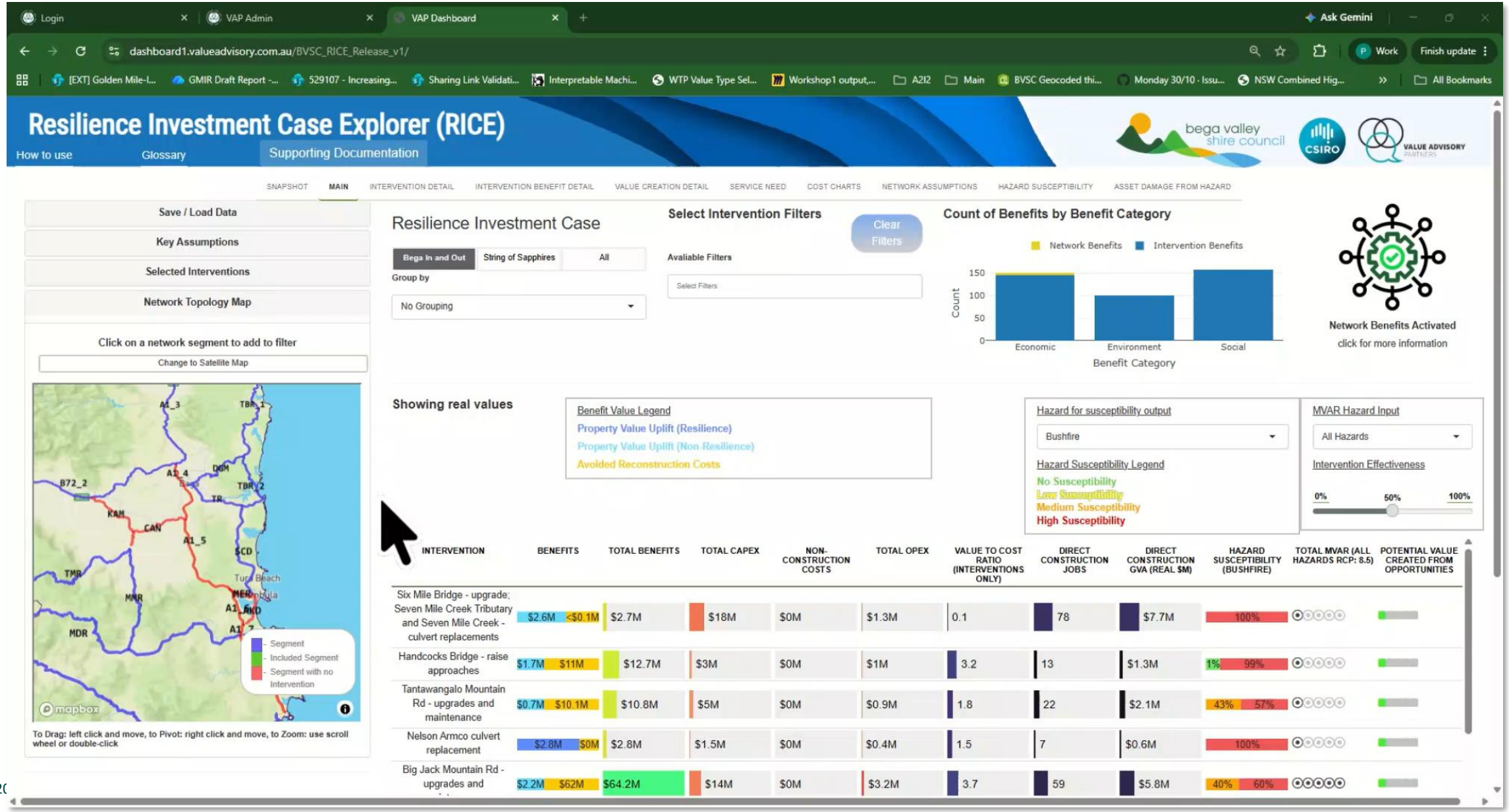


Source: Adapted from Resilience Investment Cases – Systems model, Meharg et. Al (2024). Enabling Resilience Investment: a practical manual for Bega Valley Shire Council.

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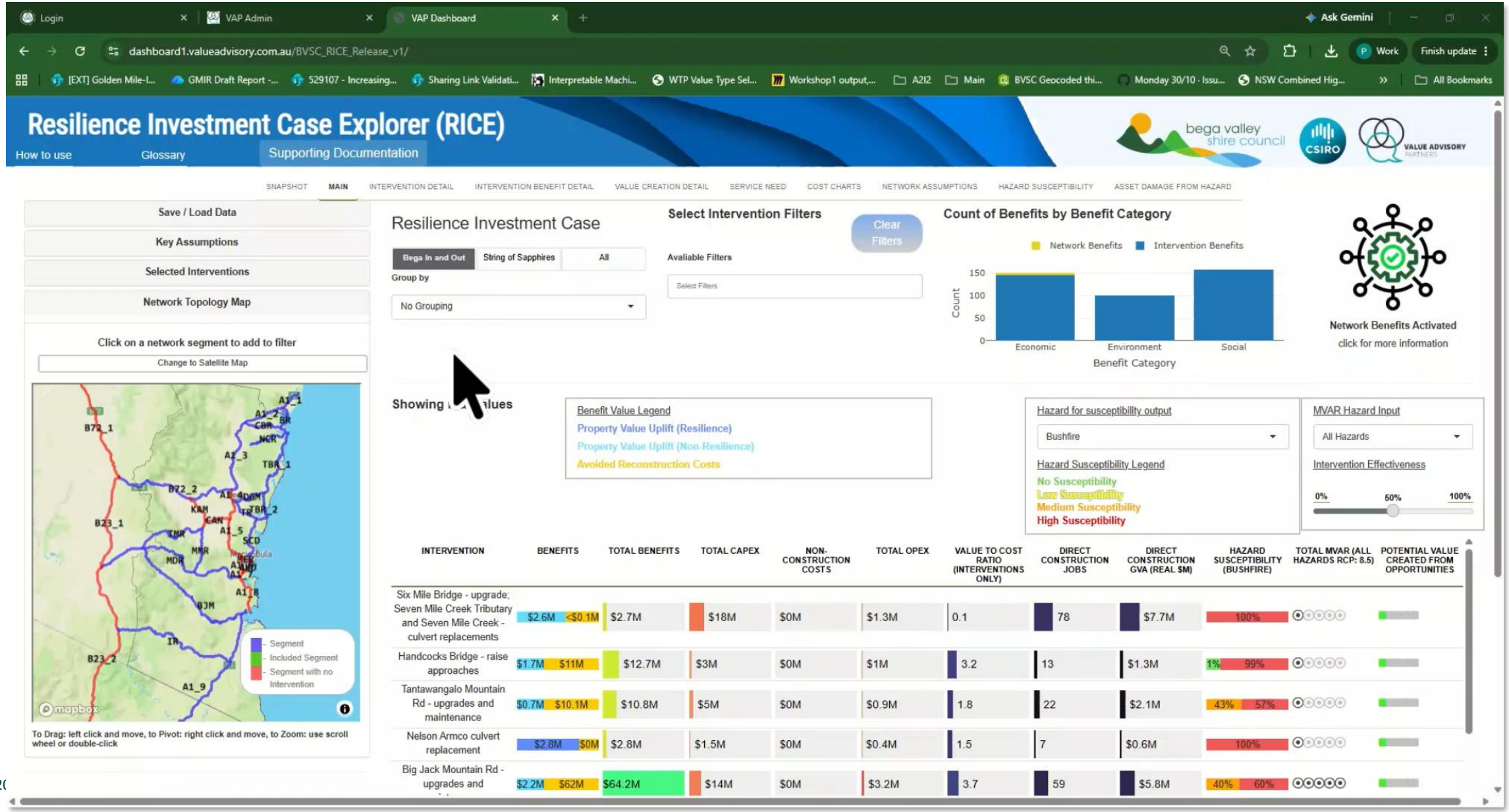
PLACE

Exploring place, networks, and systems



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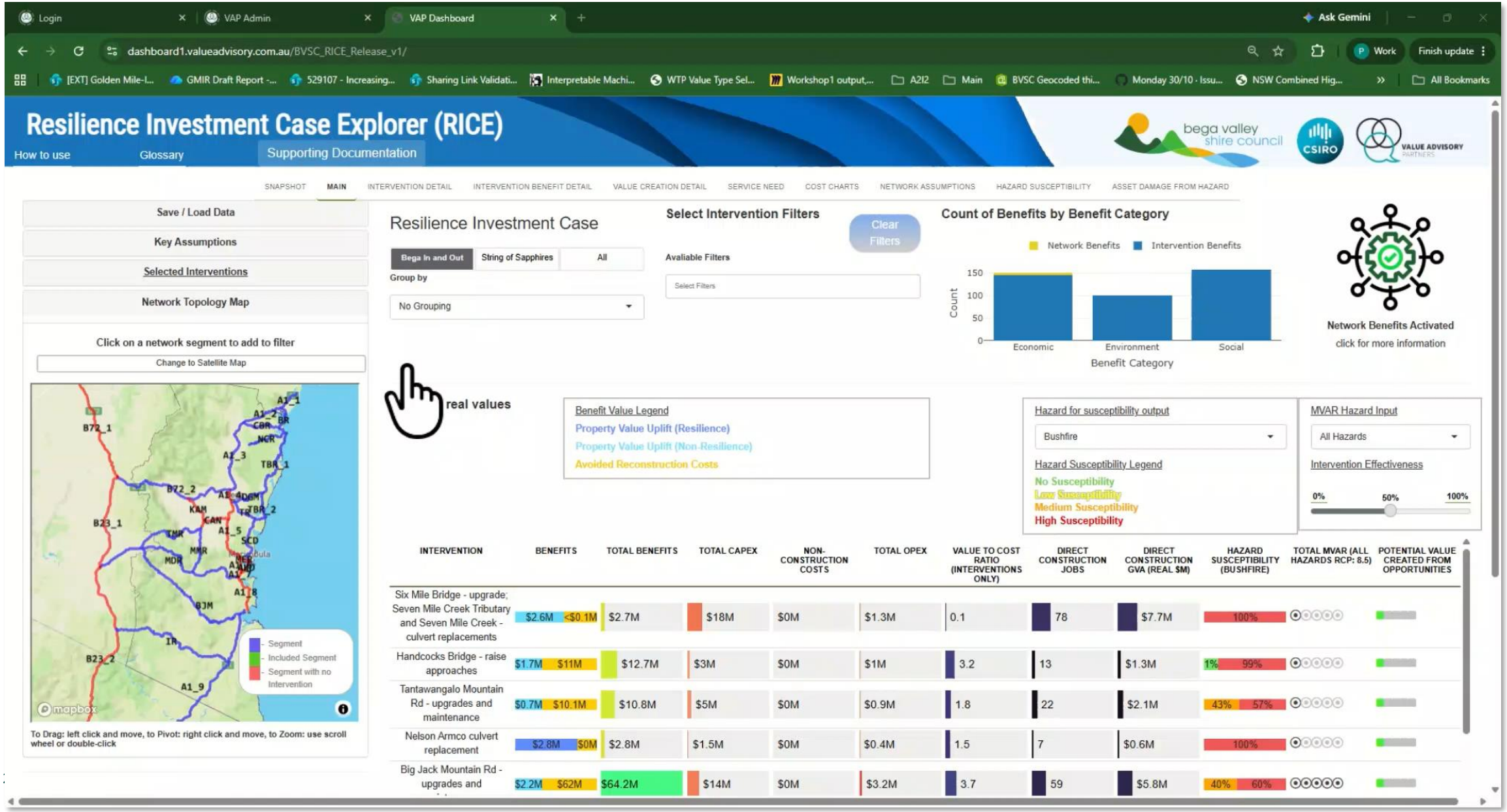
Exploring the hazard exposure and risk



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OPTIONS

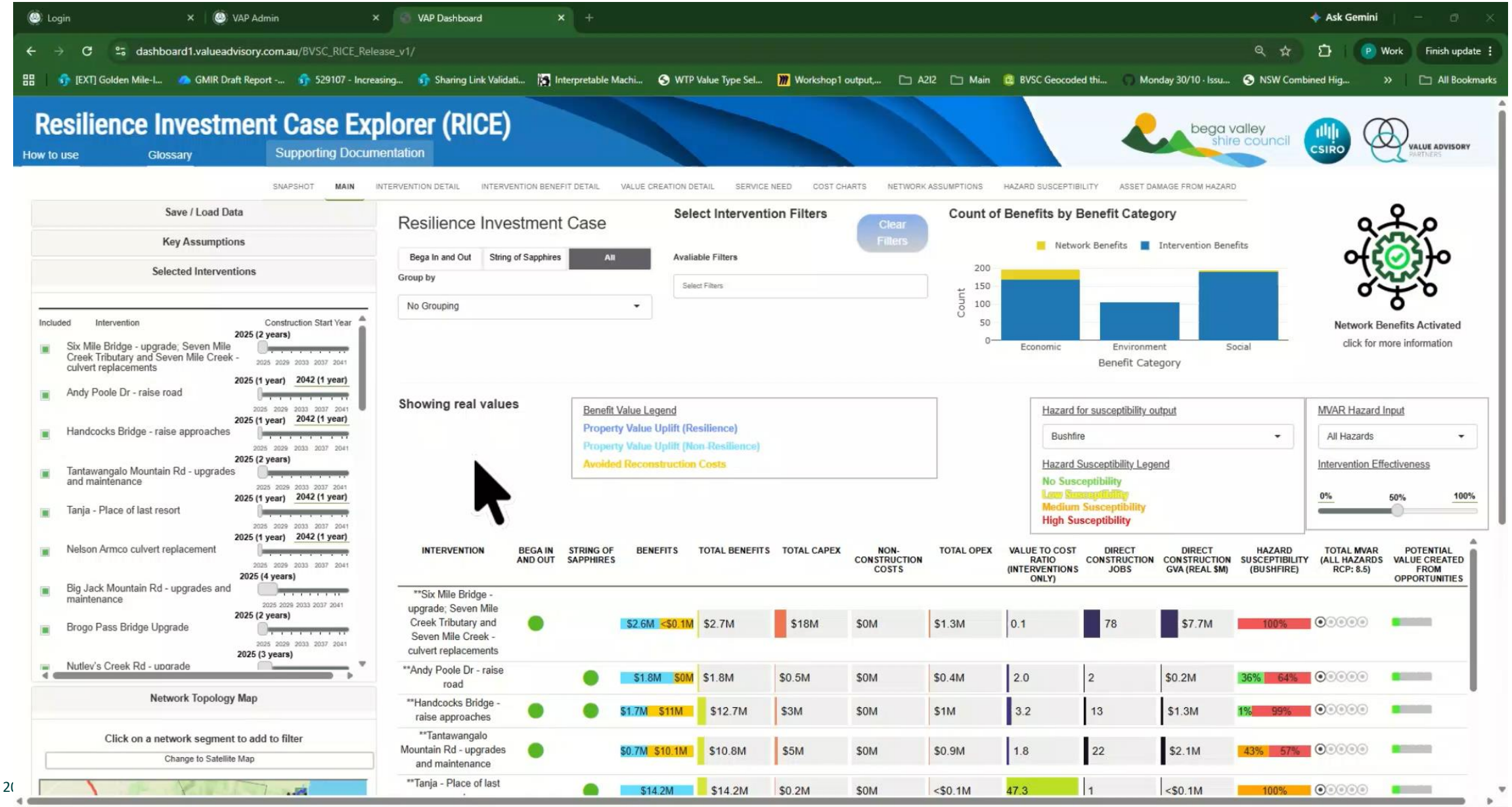
Exploring the options



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VALUE

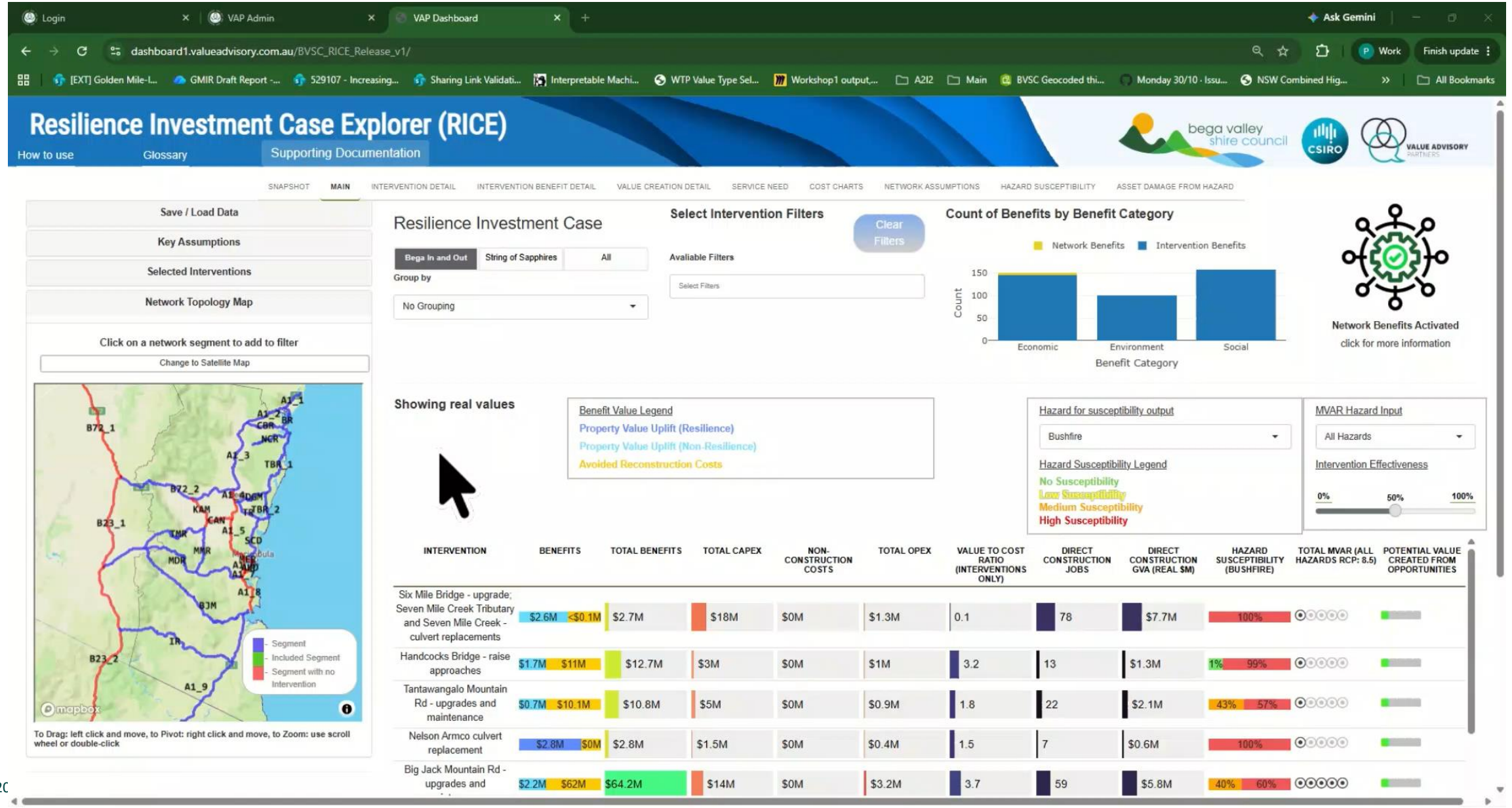
Exploring the costs, benefits, beneficiaries



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DELIVERY

Targeting funding and exploring value creation options



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One architecture can support different adaptation decisions

Local adaptation priorities

Connect place-based risk to long-term plans and capital programs

Business cases

Carry evidence into a credible investment proposition

Institutional investment

Clarify value, beneficiaries, and potential funding roles or delivery contributions

Asset planning

Embed climate risk and intervention pathways into routine decisions and operational environments

Scale comes from a repeatable decision structure, with evidence adapted to each place

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LESSONS

What makes a digital adaptation platform useful

01	**Start with the decision**	Design around the choices users need to make
02	**Preserve the evidence trail**	Keep assumptions, sources and local knowledge visible
03	**Build participation into the process**	Connect engagement directly to options and value
04	**Plan for iteration**	Update the case as hazards, assets and funding conditions change

Better adaptation decisions come from connecting people, evidence and investment logic in one usable environment



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